

NO SIDE DOOR TO BELIEF

What governs entry into durable belief —
and why transformations overwrite one
another.

FIVE STATIONS. NO SHORTCUT.



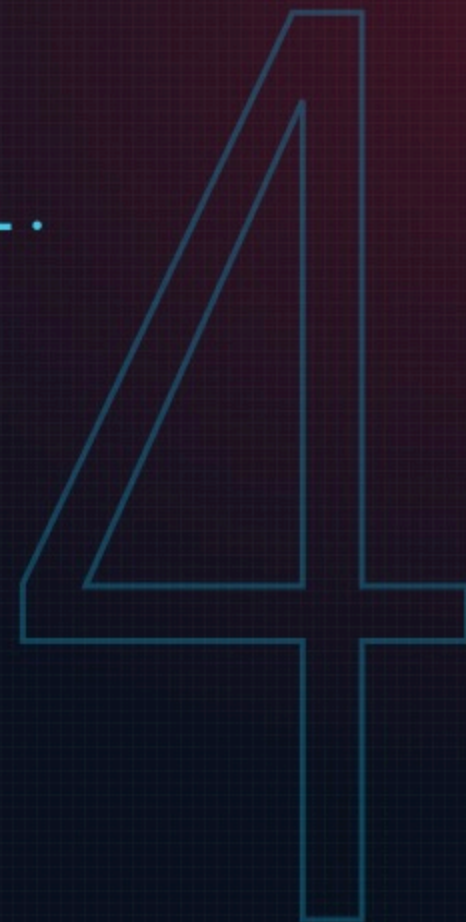
"A system that cannot decide what to believe is not a mind."

Crawford and Hammer formulate the governed path into durable belief: candidate claim → retrieve commitments → test the claim → record a verdict → make it matter.

Along with it come five conditions that close the bypass, six failure forms of the same fault and four metrics. Their term for the shortcut: **"a side door"** — a claim reaches durable status without being tested against standing commitments.

Crawford, K. & Hammer, P. (2026): Epistemic resolve — Governed uptake and the architecture of mind. AGI 2026, Part I, LNCS 16854, pp. 192–205. Springer.

WHY NOTHING ADDS UP.



Catastrophic forgetting persists because task updates interfere: learning B overwrites the shared parameters in **roughly the same directions** that A wrote.

HiBaCaML answers with a structure: a protected **hard kernel**, around it shells of decreasing stability, then typed peripheral regions. Pruning runs outside-in — the kernel is never touched.

Translated: most companies have lived through three to five major programmes in fifteen years. **Leaders rarely name more than one.**

Goertzel, B., Derr, C. & Taye, Y. (2026): Hierarchical Bayesian causal modular learning — A two-level columnar architecture for continual learning. Conference poster, 19th Conference on Artificial General Intelligence (AGI-26), San Francisco State University, 27–30 July 2026. Poster documented first-hand; proceedings entry pending.

NOT THE STRENGTH. THE TIMING.

"It is not how big the smile. It is when it lands."

Sabine works on a temporal grammar for finite systems — and in doing so formulates a sentence that applies exactly to corrections in organizations.

A correction arriving too early meets no experience. One arriving too late meets an **already consolidated belief**. Both are equally strong and act differently.

The principle is called **phase gating**: timing, not magnitude.

Sabine, A. (2026): Phase-gating across precision channels — Topological constraints on multi-channel belief update dynamics. AGI 2026, Part II, LNCS 16855, pp. 219–236. Springer.

A RITUAL. NO CONTROL.

A building with a carefully staffed reception and an unlocked delivery door has no access control. It has a ritual.

This is how organizations handle knowledge. There is the front entrance — analysis, review, committee, resolution. And there is the door through which beliefs enter the house **durably without having taken that route.**

A remark in a side conversation. A number that appears three times in slide decks and by the fourth is questioned by nobody.

FOUR YEARS. ONE WRONG NUMBER.

A supplier has held a figure to be settled: a key account makes up 30 per cent of contribution margin. Certain overheads were not allocated.

In the third year a controller recalculates: it is 19. He says so, it is noted — and **recorded nowhere**.

In the fourth year the strategy paper again reads 30 per cent. Correction latency: over twelve months, still running. The error was not the calculation. **It was the missing verdict.**

FIVE CONDITIONS

NO SIDE DOOR.

01

Retrieve the relevant standing commitments

02

Test the claim against them

03

Record the verdict in durable state — not merely in a response

04

Later reasoning, planning and action respect its status

05

Block equivalent durable effects **from skipping the test**

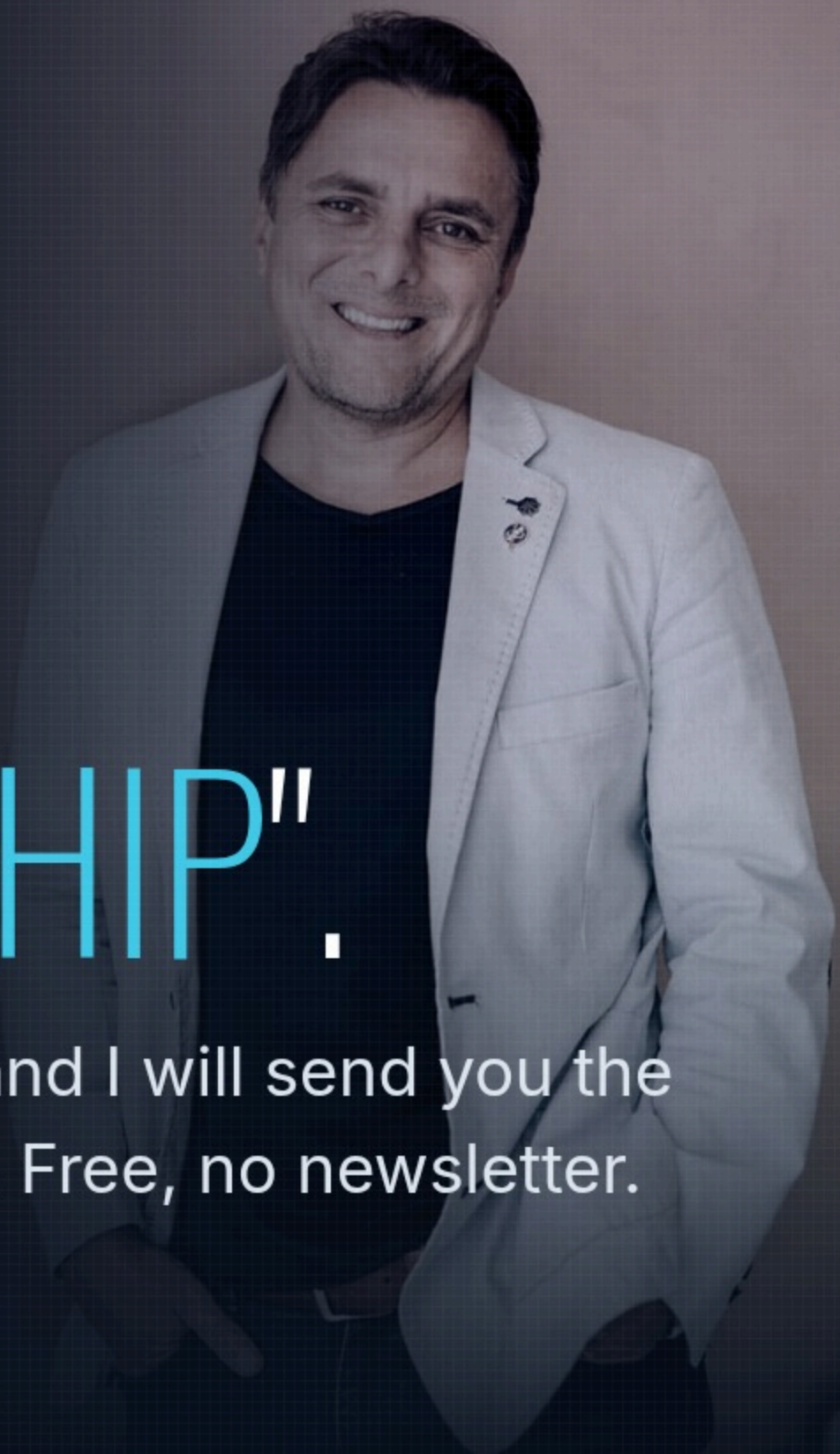
Four of the five conditions cost nothing but discipline. Only one costs structure: recording the verdict. And that is precisely the one missing — in almost every organization the result of a review is said and not stored.

EVERY PATH WITHOUT A TEST IS A BYPASS.

A claim attains durable status only via a path that retrieves the standing commitments, tests the claim against them, records a verdict and makes that verdict **binding** for later decisions — however well intentioned the shortcut.

Three of the five conditions are covered in LEAD21, one partly, one is open: the 9 Chambers carry the path from situation to adjustment without gaps.

The side door is not addressed at all. The answer of the series: Chamber 7 gains a ToBelieve field.



NEXT

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Spend one hour in your leadership team hunting the six failure forms: where does repetition count as evidence?

Gerald Huesch — developer of LEAD21, the Leadership OS. Has trained over 30,000 leaders in 30+ countries, including NASA and Rolls-Royce.

All eight papers: gerald-huesch.com/press-en